

VIRTUAL FITTING ROOM · NAIROBI

What we make on every try-on

Every try-on costs real money the moment somebody presses the button: OpenAI charges us to draw the picture, to read the garment, to read the body and to check the result. This is what comes in, what goes out, and what is left, at today's prices.

1 · What the AI charges us

Two setups, one switch in Admin for the whole system. **Saver** is on now: a small model (GPT-5.6 Luna) reads photos and checks results, and a try-on is only redone when the item or its colours came out wrong. **Premium** uses GPT-6 Astra for the same jobs and redoes any try-on that fails a check. The try-on picture itself is drawn by the same model either way, so the quality a shopper sees does not change.

JOB	PREMIUM (GPT-6 ASTRA)	SAVER (GPT-5.6 LUNA)	SAVING	SOURCE
Read a garment photo	\$0.0230 · KES 2.98	\$0.00075 · KES 0.10	97%	both measured
Check a finished try-on	\$0.0150 · KES 1.94	\$0.00120 · KES 0.16	92%	Luna measured
Read a body (once per set of photos)	\$0.0550 · KES 7.12	\$0.00180 · KES 0.23	97%	Astra measured

Token prices per million: Astra \$10 in / \$50 out, Luna \$0.20 in / \$1.20 out. Garment readings and body profiles are saved and reused, so they are paid once per garment and once per set of photos, not on every try-on.

WHAT WE PAY PER STANDARD TRY-ON	PREMIUM	SAVER
Drawing the picture (GPT Image 2.5), measured average	KES 7.12	KES 7.12
Reading and checking around it	KES 1.29	KES 0.26
Redos and the reading that gets reused (planning allowance)	KES 8.59	KES 3.62
Planning figure used everywhere below	KES 17.00	KES 11.00

Measured on the live system: a Standard try-on has cost KES 8.41 on average and KES 15.66 in the worst case (Premium). The planning figures above are deliberately higher so redos and refunds are already paid for.

2 · What a shopper pays, and what is left

Out of every shilling: the taxman takes VAT at 16%, Paystack takes 1.5%, and a store that sent the shopper takes its share. The rest pays for the AI, and what remains is ours.

Shopper came on their own (no store share)

PACK	PRICE	TRY-ONS	AFTER VAT	PAYSTACK	STORE	AI (SAVER)	PROFIT	PER TRY-ON
Launch offer (first buy)	KES 50	3	KES 43.10	-KES 0.75	—	-KES 33.00	KES 9.35	KES 3.12
Two try-ons	KES 50	2	KES 43.10	-KES 0.75	—	-KES 22.00	KES 20.35	KES 10.18
Bundle of 5	KES 120	5	KES 103.45	-KES 1.80	—	-KES 55.00	KES 46.65	KES 9.33
Bundle of 12	KES 270	12	KES 232.76	-KES 4.05	—	-KES 132.00	KES 96.71	KES 8.06

Shopper came through a store (store earns its share)

PACK	PRICE	TRY-ONS	AFTER VAT	PAYSTACK	STORE	AI (SAVER)	PROFIT	PER TRY-ON
Launch offer (first buy)	KES 50	3	KES 43.10	-KES 0.75	-KES 5.00	-KES 33.00	KES 4.35	KES 1.45
Two try-ons	KES 50	2	KES 43.10	-KES 0.75	-KES 5.00	-KES 22.00	KES 15.35	KES 7.68
Bundle of 5	KES 120	5	KES 103.45	-KES 1.80	-KES 24.00	-KES 55.00	KES 22.65	KES 4.53
Bundle of 12	KES 270	12	KES 232.76	-KES 4.05	-KES 54.00	-KES 132.00	KES 42.71	KES 3.56

The target was at least KES 10 of profit per try-on. Two try-ons for KES 50 clears it at KES 10.18 when nobody referred the shopper, and makes KES 7.68 each when a store did. The launch offer (3 for KES 50) makes about KES 3 a try-on: it is marketing, not margin, which is why it is limited to a shopper's first purchase.

3 · What Premium mode would cost us

PACK	PROFIT ON SAVER	PROFIT ON PREMIUM	DIFFERENCE PER PACK
Launch offer (first buy)	KES 9.35	KES -8.65	-KES 18.00
Two try-ons	KES 20.35	KES 8.35	-KES 12.00
Bundle of 5	KES 46.65	KES 16.65	-KES 30.00
Bundle of 12	KES 96.71	KES 24.71	-KES 72.00

Premium eats KES 6 of every try-on. On the KES 50 packs that is most of the profit, so Saver stays on unless quality complaints say otherwise. The switch is in Admin → Controls → AI setup and applies to everybody at once.

4 · Monthly plans

PLAN	PRICE	CREDITS	ALL CREDITS USED	HALF GO UNUSED	PER TRY-ON USED
Lite	KES 499	15	KES 257.69	KES 340.19	KES 17.18
Plus	KES 999	35	KES 461.22	KES 653.72	KES 13.18
Pro	KES 1,999	70	KES 923.29	KES 1,308.29	KES 13.19

Plans are the best business we have: people pay for credits they do not always use, and heavy users are capped by the daily limit. A store referral takes 20% of a plan, which is KES 100 on Lite and KES 400 on Pro.

5 · What a month looks like

Assumption: every try-on is sold at the everyday price of KES 25 (the 2 for KES 50 pack), 4 shoppers in 10 came through a store, Saver is on. Fixed costs are the list prices of what we run on.

TRY-ONS	SHOPPERS PAY	VAT	PAYSTACK	STORES	AI	PROFIT	AFTER FIXED
500	KES 12,500	-KES 1,724	-KES 188	-KES 500	-KES 5,500	KES 4,588	KES -2,735
1,000	KES 25,000	-KES 3,448	-KES 375	-KES 1,000	-KES 11,000	KES 9,177	KES 1,854
2,500	KES 62,500	-KES 8,621	-KES 938	-KES 2,500	-KES 27,500	KES 22,942	KES 15,619
5,000	KES 125,000	-KES 17,241	-KES 1,875	-KES 5,000	-KES 55,000	KES 45,884	KES 38,561
10,000	KES 250,000	-KES 34,483	-KES 3,750	-KES 10,000	-KES 110,000	KES 91,767	KES 84,444

Fixed costs assumed: Supabase Pro KES 3,235, Vercel Pro KES 2,588, domain and email KES 1,500 — KES 7,323 a month.

Break-even is about 798 Standard try-ons a month, roughly 399 packs of two. Everything above that is profit; on Premium mode break-even would be about 2,305 try-ons.

6 · What eats the margin

Refunds. A try-on that fails its checks is refunded, so we pay the AI and earn nothing. Every refund costs about KES 11 — roughly one try-on's profit, so one refund in two try-ons wipes the margin.

Bundles pay stores 20%. The KES 50 packs pay a referring store 10%, but bundles still pay 20%: KES 42.71 left on Bundle of 12 against KES 96.71 without a store. Dropping bundles to 10-15% is the single easiest win.

HD and Studio. HD costs 2 credits and Studio 4, and the picture costs us barely more than Standard, so they are more profitable than Standard, not less. Worth pushing.

Worst-case try-ons. The most expensive try-on so far cost KES 15.66. A run of difficult photos costs real money; the Admin cost table shows the average and the worst of the last 60 days.

Prices move. OpenAI can change prices at any time. The Admin switch means we can drop to Saver, or to an even smaller model, without touching the app.